

Wacom Intuos3 Graphic Tablet

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Shyam Shriram

It's like a dream in CMYK at 300 dpi: the Wacom Intuos3 tablet, a must-have for all professional digital artists. The No. 1 tablet in the world, I'm told. I'm also told it feels like pencil on paper—the ideal gadget for someone like me who wants to make the shift to fully digital. Goodbye, pencil! Goodbye, paper!

Day 1

I woke up early—this was a special day for me. I was going to buy the tablet; My Dream Tool. An Intuos3 9 x 12 inch tablet. Yes, 9 x 12; a vast virtual playground for a digital artist like me. It's actually 13 x 17, but the active area is 9 x 12.

Once in my hands, I opened the box delicately – and wow, it was a work of art. A pleasant tungsten grey, it sure had sex appeal!

There's a cute little blue light on the top. Don't know what it does, but it looks cool... Installed the drivers, which was a breeze. The foreplay over, it was time for some real pleasure. I held the grip pen and revved up Photoshop. Doodled for a long, long time in Photoshop and Corel Painter IX.

Day 2

Drawing with a tablet was not a new thing for me—I have another small tablet of a different make, which cannot compare with the Intuos3. It's sooo sensitive. Drawing is much, much more fun now. I'm on top of the world!

Day 4

Came to office with my new dream tool. It's got great flaunt value, too! And trust me, doing my daily work was now heaven!

Day 5

I got two software free with the tablet—nik Color Efex Pro 2.0 and Corel Painter Essentials 2 to experiment with. The Intuos3 is, of course, cordless and battery-free. It has another unique feature—tilt sensitivity, which makes it feel even more like pencil on paper! I can feel the difference in the strokes when I tilt the pen. It feels so realistic, it's easy to forget you aren't drawing on paper.

Day 10

The Intuos3 has 1,024 – yes, 1,024 – levels of tip and eraser (yeah, there's actually an eraser at the other end of the stick) pressure sensitivity, so I can draw

more easily. It's made just for artists like me. There are express keys and a very sensitive touch strip – much like a laptop touchpad – for zooming, panning and more. My tablet has a 200 pps (points per pixel) reporting rate, and an incredible resolution of 5,080 lines per inch.

Day 13

Drawing is now sheer joy. Thank God I am an illustrator! I can drag, zoom, pan; I can choose colours without touching the keyboard. It also has [Alt], [Ctrl], and [Shift] keys as well as a spacebar, and the best part is, it's compatible with all software. Whether it's Photoshop, Painter or Illustrator, it's a made-for-each-other kind of feeling.

Day 18

Just discovered that the Intuos3 has three types of nibs for different drawing experiences. It has a 'Standard' nib; a 'Stroke' nib that includes a dual-spring action for extended tip travel—a real brush-like experience; and a 'Felt' nib designed for a pencil-on-paper feel. Imagine being able to customise the nib according to what you're drawing!

Day 30

By now, I've minimised the use of paper and pencil, because I have The Power Of The Intuos3. Got to leave now—my beauty beckons!

shyam_shriram@thinkdigit.com